US Retail Sales (Sep 2026) Pre-Event Book — English twin (v20261015-1805)

Release: Thu 2026-10-15 08:30 ET = 20:30 SGT | CONFIRMED (census.gov retail release schedule). Same second as PPI (locked separately v20261014-1806), jobless claims, Philly Fed, Empire. Snapshot locked 2026-10-15 18:05 SGT. Not investment advice.

Executive summary

- **Context (FACT):** Fed hiked 25bp on 9/16 to 3.75–4.00% ("removed a dose of accommodation"). Sep CPI +0.6% m/m / 3.7% y/y, core +0.3% / 2.6%. Oct-28 hike odds jumped from ~22% to 33–49% (CME FedWatch via WSJ/Cboe/Yahoo, 10/14). 2Y 4.79%, 10Y 5.21% (FRED).
- **MARKET EXP:** headline **+0.3%**, ex-auto **+0.5%** (investingLive via Admiral 10/14; Action Economics survey median), control group **+0.3%** (Action Economics median, range −0.1 to +0.5).
- **OS HYPOTHESIS (below consensus):** headline +0.2%, ex-auto +0.4%, **control 0.0%** — Prime Day timing payback in nonstore after Aug +2.3–2.6%; gasoline lifts nominal headline but squeezes real spending. Moderate-low confidence (relies on two third-party previews).
- **Scenarios (calibrated):** Weak 25% / Inline 55% / Strong 20%. Base rate: ≤0.0% 33%, mid 36%, ≥0.7% 31% over 36m (FRED RSAFS). Calibration applied: True shrunk: [].
- **Why it matters:** in a hiking cycle, strong demand = higher Oct hike odds = pressure on long-duration growth multiples. Weak retail + hot PPI = stagflation read, not a clean rally.

Live checklist (20:30 SGT)

#	Watch	Weak	Strong
1	Control group MoM	≤−0.2%	≥+0.6%
2	Headline MoM	≤0.0%	≥0.7%
3	Gasoline stations	—	big rise = price, not volume
4	Nonstore/online	clearly negative	still rising (falsifies our view)
5	Autos	negative	positive (TSLA read)
6	Aug revision	down	up ≥0.3pp

#	Watch	Weak	Strong
7	Food services	negative	strong (CCL proxy)
8	2Y first 15 min	≤−4bp	≥+4bp (attribute vs PPI via 2×2 matrix)
9	Initial claims (cons ~195–200k)	≥215k	≤190k
10	Philly (cons 28.4) / Empire (cons 10.3)	well below	well above

Affected names

Consumer: AAPL, TSLA, CCL. Rate-sensitive: ARM, PLTR, RKLB, CRWV, CRWD, MRVL. AI chain (NVDA/AVGO/TSM/MU) is driven today by TSMC's results — don't attribute to retail.

Falsifiers

1. Control ≥+0.5% with nonstore still positive → payback thesis wrong. 2. Strong print but 2Y <+2bp → retail low weight in reaction function. 3. Weak print but consumer names rally → market trades rates, not demand. 4. Strong headline/weak control but breakevens spike → gasoline second-round fear. 5. Big Aug upward revision → level stronger than MoM suggests.

Friday follow-ups (post only)

Import prices Fri 08:30 ET = 20:30 SGT; Industrial production & capacity utilization Fri 09:15 ET = 21:15 SGT (both CONFIRMED). IP consensus not verified — not invented.

Self-challenge

Our below-consensus lean rests on secondary previews; PPI may dominate the 2Y tonight; Warsh (Fri 11:30 SGT) may override both.

Sources and assumptions: see ZH book §10–12 (same ledger). Charts in `images/`.